

The Chair of Operations Management, in cooperation with **zooplus**, is offering a

Project Study

on the topic

Evaluation and Optimization of the zooplus Parcel Forecast

About zooplus

zooplus is **Europe's leading online platform for pet supplies**, serving millions of pet parents across **more than 30 countries**. With a strong focus on customer satisfaction, data driven decision-making, and operational excellence, zooplus continuously innovates to deliver a reliable, efficient, and delightful shopping experience for pets and their owners.

Scope

Accurate forecasting of parcel volumes is a critical foundation for operational planning at zooplus. The parcel forecast influences capacity booking decisions across the entire logistics network — including fulfillment centers (FCs), linehauls, and delivery service providers (DSPs).

A **high forecast** can lead to **unnecessary costs** due to excess booked capacity. A **low forecast** can cause **delays and poor customer delivery experience**, as insufficient capacity leads to longer delivery lead times.

The goal of this project study is to:

- **Evaluate the current parcel forecast** quality on different aggregation levels (total volume, country-level granularity).
- **Assess** structural biases, variance, seasonality patterns, and operational drivers.
- **Identify improvement potential**, both analytically and operationally.
- Develop recommendations for forecasting enhancements (model logic, inputs, segmentation, stability).
- Propose actionable improvements that can help zooplus optimize cost efficiency while preserving excellent delivery performance.

Students will work closely with the S&OP/E and forecasting team and gain insights into e-commerce logistics, forecasting methodologies, and real-world supply chain challenges. Furthermore students will get a working student contract (20 hrs/week) for the duration of the project.

Requirements

- Strong interest in forecasting, data analytics, and e-commerce operations
- Solid knowledge of Operations Research and forecasting models
- Outstanding analytical and quantitative skills
- Experience with Python and Excel; Bonus: SQL, Tableau and PowerBI
- Ability to handle and interpret real operational datasets
- Reliability, structured working style, and attention to detail

Start and duration: October 2026; duration: 6 months part-time (paid)

Language: German or English

Number of participants: 2-4

Supervisor TUM: Aziz Boushih, Research Assistant

Supervisor zooplus: Sebastian Ceglec, Head of S&OP/E and Forecasting

Contact: If you are interested, please contact aziz.boushih@tum.de